

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 6 4 3
 ♥ 9 7 6 2
 ♦ 9 2
 ♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q J 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♦	1♥	2♥
Dbl	6♦		
All Pass			

6♦ by North

You want to play the first ♣ from dummy, so enter dummy with a trump.

Play the ♣10 from dummy and let it ride if West does not produce the ♣Q or ♣K. East will win with one of the honors but will have to return another ♣ or give you a ruff-sluff.

When you are missing the K Q of a suit, as in the ♣s on this hand, taking two finesses gives you a 75% chance of success - **all things being equal**.

In this case though, East's overcall means all things are not equal, so your chances are lower than 75%.

But never mind the percentages for a finesse, the end-play was a sure thing.

South's 2♥ bid showed a hand with limit raise or better in ♦s. North doesn't bother with Blackwood since he already knows about the Aces. He just bids the slam. North plays 6♦. East leads the ♥K, won by you with the ♥A.

The good news is that you have no losers in ♠s, ♥, or ♦s. The bad news is that you have two losers in ♣s. The good news is that missing the ♣ K Q you could try two finesses. The bad news is that East overcalled, so he probably has both honors. The best news of all is that you know how to pull off an elimination play!. Play a trump to dummy's ♦K (East discards a ♥) and ruff the ♥5.

Pull the outstanding trump with the ♦A, then play ♠A, ♠K and ruff a ♠.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ A J 7

♦ A 4

♣ Q J 8 7 3

♠ A 6 5

♥ Q 9 8 2

♦ 10 8 7 6 2

♣ 5



♠ K 4

♥ K 10 3

♦ K 9 5

♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 10 8 7

♥ 6 5 4

♦ Q J 3

♣ K 4

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

Pass

3 ♣

Pass

5 ♣

All Pass

5 ♣ by East

West's cue-bid shows a limit raise or better (11 points) in ♣s. East is to play 5 ♣. South leads the ♠Q, North takes the ♠A and returns the ♠6 to your ♠K.

You have lost one trick already and have a possible loser in trumps and another possible loser in ♥s. Both losers can be avoided with successful finesses. The problem with the ♣ finesse is that South made an overcall so he is more likely to hold the ♣K. If you don't try the ♣ finesse you may be able to throw a defender in with the ♣K at a time when he will have to help you with his next play.

After winning the ♠K immediately play the ♣A.

It would have been nice to see the ♣K fall, but it didn't. So play a small ♦ to dummy's ♦A and play the ♠9, ruffing in your hand.

Eliminate the ♦s by playing ♦K, then ruffing your last ♦ in dummy.

You have done all the eliminating, time to throw in somebody. Play a ♣.

Whichever defender had the ♣K is now on lead, but wishes he wasn't. If he plays a ♥ you get a free finesse. If he plays anything else you get a ruff-sluff.

If you had finessed for the ♣K South would have won the trick and been able to make a safe exit, probably with his other ♣.

You would then have been forced to rely on the ♥ finesse, and with South being the defender who showed some strength, you would likely have finessed through him.

About the only way the elimination/throw-in could fail is if the ♣s split 3-0. Then, if you play Ace and another the defender who wins would use his third ♣ as a safe exit.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥	Pass	5♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South

Conveniently in dummy, you play a ♣ and insert the ♣10 if East plays low.

[showcards N:HA,H6,C7,C6 S:HK,HQ,CA,CQ]

West will probably win this trick. If he wins with the ♣K then your hand is good. If he wins with the ♣J then he is end-played, forced to either lead a ♣ into your ♣ A Q or to give you a ruff-sluff.

You probably noticed that you could have finessed your ♣Q on the first ♣ play and pulled off the end-play just as effectively. But there is an advantage to making the first finesse with the ♣10.

If East just happens to hold both the ♣K and ♣J you will make all thirteen tricks if your first finesse is with the ♣10!

Your 3♥ bid is a slam suggestion. After you show the ♣A partner wastes no time in bidding it.

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠K.

This is a good slam. You have only two possible ♣ losers, and by taking two ♣ finesses you have an excellent chance of success. But by using an elimination play you will have a sure thing.

Win the ♠A and ruff a ♠ with a ♥ honor.

Play a small ♥ to dummy's ♥9 and ruff another ♠. Both defenders followed to the trump play.

Play another ♥ to dummy's ♥10 and ruff the last ♠.

Play the ♦A and ♦K.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3



♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q J 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ A J 7
♦ A 4
♣ Q J 8 7 3

♠ A 6 5
♥ Q 9 8 2
♦ 10 8 7 6 2
♣ 5



♠ K 4
♥ K 10 3
♦ K 9 5
♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 10 8 7
♥ 6 5 4
♦ Q J 3
♣ K 4

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3



♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q J 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ A J 7

♦ A 4

♣ Q J 8 7 3

♠ A 6 5

♥ Q 9 8 2

♦ 10 8 7 6 2

♣ 5



♠ K 4

♥ K 10 3

♦ K 9 5

♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 10 8 7

♥ 6 5 4

♦ Q J 3

♣ K 4

Board 9

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3



♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q J 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

Board 11

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ A J 7
♦ A 4
♣ Q J 8 7 3

♠ A 6 5
♥ Q 9 8 2
♦ 10 8 7 6 2
♣ 5



♠ K 4
♥ K 10 3
♦ K 9 5
♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 10 8 7
♥ 6 5 4
♦ Q J 3
♣ K 4

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

Board 13

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3



♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q J 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ A J 7

♦ A 4

♣ Q J 8 7 3

♠ A 6 5

♥ Q 9 8 2

♦ 10 8 7 6 2

♣ 5



♠ K 4

♥ K 10 3

♦ K 9 5

♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 10 8 7

♥ 6 5 4

♦ Q J 3

♣ K 4

Board 15

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3



♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q J 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

Board 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ A J 7

♦ A 4

♣ Q J 8 7 3

♠ A 6 5

♥ Q 9 8 2

♦ 10 8 7 6 2

♣ 5



♠ K 4

♥ K 10 3

♦ K 9 5

♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 10 8 7

♥ 6 5 4

♦ Q J 3

♣ K 4

Board 18

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

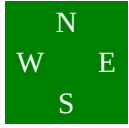
♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

Board 19

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3



♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q J 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

Board 20

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ A J 7
♦ A 4
♣ Q J 8 7 3

♠ A 6 5
♥ Q 9 8 2
♦ 10 8 7 6 2
♣ 5



♠ K 4
♥ K 10 3
♦ K 9 5
♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 10 8 7
♥ 6 5 4
♦ Q J 3
♣ K 4

Board 21

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

Board 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3



♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q J 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

Board 23

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ A J 7

♦ A 4

♣ Q J 8 7 3

♠ A 6 5

♥ Q 9 8 2

♦ 10 8 7 6 2

♣ 5



♠ K 4

♥ K 10 3

♦ K 9 5

♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 10 8 7

♥ 6 5 4

♦ Q J 3

♣ K 4

Board 24

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

Board 25

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3



♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q J 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

Board 26

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ A J 7

♦ A 4

♣ Q J 8 7 3

♠ A 6 5

♥ Q 9 8 2

♦ 10 8 7 6 2

♣ 5



♠ K 4

♥ K 10 3

♦ K 9 5

♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 10 8 7

♥ 6 5 4

♦ Q J 3

♣ K 4

Board 27

South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 10 3
♥ 2
♦ 10 8 7 2
♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2
♥ A 10 9 6
♦ A K
♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4
♥ 8
♦ J 9 6 4 3
♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5
♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3
♦ Q 5
♣ A Q 10

Board 28

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3



♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q J 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

Board 29

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ A J 7

♦ A 4

♣ Q J 8 7 3

♠ A 6 5

♥ Q 9 8 2

♦ 10 8 7 6 2

♣ 5



♠ K 4

♥ K 10 3

♦ K 9 5

♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 10 8 7

♥ 6 5 4

♦ Q J 3

♣ K 4

Board 30

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

Board 31

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3



♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q J 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

Board 32

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ A J 7
♦ A 4
♣ Q J 8 7 3

♠ A 6 5
♥ Q 9 8 2
♦ 10 8 7 6 2
♣ 5



♠ K 4
♥ K 10 3
♦ K 9 5
♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 10 8 7
♥ 6 5 4
♦ Q J 3
♣ K 4

Board 33

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10

Board 34

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 6 2

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 6

♠ A J

♥ A

♦ A 10 8 7 4 3

♣ A J 9 3



♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q J 10 8 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 4 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J 6 5

♣ 10 7 5

Board 35

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ A J 7
♦ A 4
♣ Q J 8 7 3

♠ A 6 5
♥ Q 9 8 2
♦ 10 8 7 6 2
♣ 5



♠ K 4
♥ K 10 3
♦ K 9 5
♣ A 10 9 6 2

♠ Q J 10 8 7
♥ 6 5 4
♦ Q J 3
♣ K 4

Board 36

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 2

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 8 6 2

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ A K

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ J 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 8 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A Q 10